

In Rizal's second trip to Europe, he became more active in fighting for reforms. Not through weapons, but through his writings. During this period, he worked with other educated Filipinos called the **Ilustrados** to expose the problems under Spanish rule and encourage peaceful change.

What is an Ilustrados?

- Ilustrados comes from the Spanish word 'Ilustrado', which means 'enlightened' or 'educated'

These were educated Filipinos who studied mostly in Europe. Instead of violence, they used book, newspapers, essays, etc. to fight for the rights and freedom of Filipinos.

Who were his fellow Ilustrados?

1. Marcelo H. Del Pilar
2. Graciano Lopez Jaena
3. Antonio Luna
4. Mariano Ponce
5. Trinidad Pardo de Tavera

The Propaganda Movement

- Rizal joined the propaganda movement which is a peaceful reform that wanted Spain to treat Filipinos fairly.

3 Main Goals of the Propaganda:

- Make the Philippines the province of Spain so Filipinos would enjoy the same rights as the Spanish citizens
- Representation of the Spanish Cortes, means a Congress of Spain. Which wanted Filipino representatives to have a voice in making laws.
- Secularization of Parishes. Secularization means transferring the administration of churches from Spanish religious orders to Filipino priest. They believe that Filipino priest should also be trusted to lead churches.

LA SOLIDARIDAD

Rizal became one of the writers in La Solidaridad. La Solidaridad was the official newspaper of the Propaganda Movement. It became the voice of Filipinos in Europe, exposing the abuse of the Spanish government.

Rizal's Important Works

1. Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas (1890)
 - This was originally written by **Antonio de Morga**, but Rizal added his own notes and explanations.
 - Rizal proved that **Filipinos already had a rich culture and civilization even before the Spaniards arrived.**
 - This challenged the Spanish claim that they "civilized" the Philippines.

2. Sobre la Indolencia de los Filipinos
 - It means **"On the Indolence of the Filipinos."**
 - Many Spaniards accused Filipinos of being lazy.
 - Rizal explained that Filipinos were **not naturally lazy.**
 - Instead, he said their lack of productivity was caused by:
 - unfair treatment
 - poverty
 - excessive taxes
 - forced labor
 - poor government
 - social problems
 - People become less productive when they are oppressed.

3. Filipinas Dentro de Cien Años
 - "The Philippines a Century Hence."
 - In this essay, Rizal predicted what could happen to the Philippines in the future.
 - He warned Spain that if it continued abusing Filipinos, the people would eventually fight for their freedom.

4. El Filibusterismo (1891)
 - While living in Brussels, he finished his second novel which is the "El Filibusterismo"
 - It was published on **September 18, 1891**, with the help of his friend **Valentin Ventura.**
 - Compared to Noli Me Tangere, this novel was darker and more revolutionary.

Returning to the Philippines (1892)

- After years in Europe, Rizal realized that the real struggle was back home. So, despite warnings and his family's objections, he returned to the Philippines on **June 26, 1892**. Soon after arriving, he encouraged Filipinos to join a new organization called **La Liga Filipina**.

La Liga Filipina

- A peaceful civic organization founded by Rizal on **July 3, 1892**.
- Only three days after founding La Liga Filipina, Rizal was arrested on **July 6, 1892**.
- Spanish authorities accused him of bringing copies of a leaflet called **Pobres Frailes**.

Exile to Dapitan

Instead of being set free, Rizal was sent into exile in **Dapitan, Mindanao**.

Although he was far from Manila, he continued helping Filipinos by: